

Course Syllabus (Version 15 June 2025)**GRAD-E1368: The Politics of Food****1. General information**

Course Format	Onsite
Instructor(s)	Harry Bauer, PhD
Instructor's e-mail	h.bauer@hertie-school.org
Assistant	Adjunct support team Email: adjunctsupport@hertie-school.org
Instructor's Office Hours	Thu, 12.30h – 14.00h (teaching time only; no office hours in exam weeks, semester breaks & on public holidays) via MS Teams and by appointment only.

Link to [Study, Examination and Admission Rules and MIA, MDS and MPP Module Handbooks](#)

For information on **course times, session dates and course locations** please consult the [Course plan](#) on *MyStudies*.

Instructor Information:

Harry Bauer is a member of the Hertie School Adjunct Faculty whose research focuses on governance, authority, and organisational adaptation in an increasingly complex global landscape. Drawing on perspectives from international relations, environmental politics, social theory, and food politics, he explores how authority is exercised and contested across public and private spheres. He is especially interested in how organisations respond to change and navigate challenging environments.

Prior to joining Hertie School, Harry held academic positions at University College London, the London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), and the Universities of Mannheim and Trier. Alongside his academic work, he has extensive editorial experience. He served as Chief Editor of *Millennium: Journal of International Studies*, overseeing the journal's successful reorganisation, and worked as International Associate Editor for *openDemocracy*. Harry also maintains a longstanding interest in food. A trained cheesemonger, he works as a consultant in food research and development, bringing together scholarly and practical perspectives on the politics, culture, and governance of food systems.

2. Course Contents and Learning Objectives**Course contents:**

The questions of how and what we eat has become a key topic for public debate. Indeed, the issue of food manifests itself in different forms that are often vehicles for new understandings of the self, the nation, the environment and/ or the planet; just take the rise of consumer and farmer movements that oppose industrialised food production and worry about the future of agricultural sustainability or take the growing focus on food and cuisine in the media and other cultural industries.

Drawing on a number of disciplines, this course places food production, distribution and consumption at the centre of scrutiny. Like many other areas of life, it takes the world of food to be a world of politics and power—a world in which policy-makers, economists, environmentalists, agribusinesses, scientists, consumers, and social justice groups, all holding vastly different views,

seek to influence the food system and related policies. Hence, the world of food and the way our food systems work and worked offers important insights into the interplay of power, politics and identity—including relations between developing and developed countries, between genders as well as people and the natural world.

It is through the lens of food that this course will hence explore some of the major challenges of our time, like: food, self and identity; food and cultural heritage; food and migration; food and the nation; food, the media and popular culture; the political economy of human-environment relations; food and the consumer society; food poverty and the politics of food waste; state policy and the healthy body politic; food and the 'moral economy'; the future of food production and consumption.

Main learning objectives:

By the end of the course, students will have

- acquired familiarity with the diverse perspectives used to look at food;
- acquired an in-depth knowledge of the main issues in the field of global food politics and policy;
- analysed the role of various actors and institutions involved in the production, distribution and consumption of food;
- grown awareness of the political dimensions of food.

Teaching style:

The course consists of **12 two-hour classes**. All **sessions combine different forms of learning**, which can encompass group work, simulations, text discussions and applied research exercises.

For every weekly class, there is a **detailed guide available on Moodle outlining how to prepare**. These guides point to the essential readings listed in the syllabus and suggest a number of preparatory tasks. The required readings are intended to provide a basis for class discussion, to introduce key concepts and issues, and to act as a starting point for more advanced, independent enquiry of particular topics. Additional texts usually point to more specific questions and empirical cases. **It is essential that students follow the weekly preparatory guide.**

It is suggested that students **prepare brief notes/ outlines** of each week's readings, which can be used as discussion notes during the seminar and as background notes for your written assignments. Having notes during your essay writing will save much time and effort and improve the quality of your texts significantly!

Prerequisites:

An open and inquisitive mind.

Diversity Statement:

The topics we cover in this class are often difficult, not just intellectually but emotionally. While I expect there to be rigorous discussion and even disagreement in our class discussions, I ask that you engage in debate with care and empathy for the other members in the classroom. Aim to disagree without becoming disagreeable. In this class we will not shy away from the uncomfortable. Critically examining and assessing assumptions and basic values is not just one of our tasks in this course but is an activity vital to living an authentic life. I urge you to have the courage to face the uncomfortable in this class. In exchange for your courage, I will work to ensure a classroom environment that supports you taking these intellectual and sometimes emotional risks.

3. Grading and Assignments

The course requires **two written assignments (one short, one longer)** and one class question for five sessions. All assignments are due via Moodle. **Separate handouts** will outline the requirements of the respective assignments; they also introduce specific expectations and marking criteria in more detail.

Policy on the use of AI tools for assignments

The use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT) is not permitted. Students must adhere to the specific instructions provided for each assignment. Where AI tools are used, students are expected to clearly indicate how they were used and to ensure the originality and academic integrity of their work. **Students must include a Statement of Authorship and AI Use (StAAIU) in all written assignments.** The respective form to use is provided on the course Moodle page. Improper or undisclosed use of AI tools may be considered a violation of academic integrity policies. Please consult the course instructor in case of doubt. Further guidance is available in the [Artificial Intelligence Tools at the Hertie School—Teaching Guidelines for Instructors and Students](#), including a template for the **Statement of Authorship, under section 1.1.**

Composition of Final Grade:

Assignment 1: 800-word reflection paper	Deadline: 12 October 2026, 15.00h	Submit via Moodle	30%
Assignment 2: 2.500-word concept paper	Deadline: 16 December 2026, 15.00h	Submit via Moodle	40%
Class Questions for five sessions	Deadline: Continuous	Submit via Moodle	20%
Participation grade			10%

Assignment Details

Assignment 1

This 800-word **reflection paper** asks you to reflect on a dish that is of significance to you through one of the analytical lenses we discuss in class. This might be the notion of identity, commodity chains, biopolitics or sustainability. For more details see the separate guide available on the course Moodle page.

Assignment 2

This 2.500-word paper develops and unpacks the **concept for sustainable food for a future Hertie School canteen**. The paper outlines the key principles and practices the canteen should follow, and showcases how those principles manifest themselves in one afternoon service. For more details see the separate guide available on the course Moodle page.

Class Questions

Students need to engage with the mandatory weekly readings for each session and submit two questions concerning one of these readings via Moodle at least 48 hours before five class sessions. The submitted set of questions is meant to help me prepare teaching the subject of the week, i.e. the question can point to a matter of comprehension, can question or criticise a reading. For more details see the separate guide available on the course Moodle page.

Participation grade

Students are expected to prepare for all classes and will be called upon to answer questions relating to the readings. Students will be evaluated on their preparation and participation for class, especially those classes which are highly interactive. Generally, the participation grade is based on the assumption that students take part not as passive consumers of knowledge but as active participants in the exchange, production, and critique of ideas—their own ideas and the ideas of others. Therefore, students should come to class not only having read and viewed the materials assigned for that day but also prepared to discuss the readings of the day and to contribute thoughtfully to the conversation. Participation is marked by its active nature, its consistency, and its quality.

Late submission of assignments: Late submission of assignments leads to a grade reduction (submission within 24 hours of the deadline = 10%-point deduction; submission within 48 hours of deadline = 20%-point deduction, etc.).

Violations of the word limit: All assignments in this course come with a **strict word limit**. The word limit does not include 'administrative' sections of the assignment: the cover or title page, table of contents, table of figures, reference list, list of works cited, bibliography, footnotes or any appendices. Footnotes (where they are used), however, should only include page and publication references. You must state the word-count on the first page of your assignments. A violation of the word limit incurs a penalty (<5% = 5%-point deduction; >5% = 15%-point deduction; >20% = 30%-point deduction).

Attendance: Students are expected to be present and prepared for every class session. Active participation during lectures and seminar discussions is essential. If unavoidable circumstances arise which prevent attendance or preparation, the instructor should be advised by email with as much advance notice as possible. Please note that students cannot miss more than two out of 12 course sessions. For further information please consult the [Examination Rules](#) §10.

Academic Integrity: The Hertie School is committed to the standards of good academic and ethical conduct. Any violation of these standards shall be subject to disciplinary action. Plagiarism, misuse of AI, free riding in group work, and other deceitful actions are not tolerated. See [Examination Rules](#) §16, the Hertie [Plagiarism Policy](#), and [the Hertie Guidelines for Artificial Intelligence Tools](#). Detailed course-specific AI guidelines can be found on the course Moodle page. All assignments in this course will be checked by [Original](#), a plagiarism detection system.

Compensation for Disadvantages: If a student furnishes evidence that he or she is not able to take an examination as required in whole or in part due to disability or permanent illness, the Examination Committee may upon written request approve learning accommodation(s). In this respect, the submission of adequate certificates may be required. See [Examination Rules](#) §14.

Extenuating circumstances: An extension can be granted due to extenuating circumstances (i.e., for reasons like illness, personal loss or hardship, or caring duties). In such cases, please contact the course instructors and the Examination Office *in advance* of the deadline.

4. General Readings

- Barber, Dan. 2014. *The Third Plate: Field Notes on the Future of Food*. London: Abacus.
- Bittmann, Mark. 2021. *Animal, Vegetable, Junk*. Boston: Houghton Mifflin Harcourt.
- Clapp, Jennifer. 2016. *Food*. 2nd ed. London: Polity.
- Metcalfe, Robyn Shotwell. 2019. *Food Routes: Growing Bananas in Iceland and Other Tales from the Logistics of Eating*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- Pollan, Michael. 2007. *The Omnivore's Dilemma*. London: Penguin

5. Session Overview

Course session times and dates can be found in the [Course Plan](#) on *MyStudies*.

Session	Session Title
1	Talking about Food
2	'You Eat what you Are'—Tastes, Cultures & Identity
3	The World Food Economy—the Past: <i>Sweetness & Power</i>
4	The World Food Economy—the Present
5	The Political Economy of Food Regulation
6	The State & the Healthy 'Body Politic'—Pregnancy, Dietary Recommendations & Science
7	Food Sustainability – Concepts & Diagnosis
Semester break: no class	
8	Food Sustainability – Actions & Practices
9	Food Deserts, Food Swamps & Food Poverty
10	Food Security & National Food Strategies
11	Food as Social & Political Catalyst—Social Movements, Food Production & Consumption
12	The Future of Food Production & Consumption
Final Exam Week: no class	

5. Course Sessions and Readings

All readings will be accessible on the Moodle course site before semester start. In the case that there is a change in readings, students will be notified by email. Required readings are to be read and analysed thoroughly. Optional readings are intended to broaden your knowledge in the respective area, and it is highly recommended to at least skim them.

Session 1: Talking about Food	
Learning Objective	This session introduces into the course and explores the way we can talk about food.
Required Readings	- Pilcher, Jeffrey M. 2016. 'Culinary Infrastructure: How Facilities and Technologies Create Value and Meaning Around Food'. <i>Global Food History</i> 2: 105-31. - Wilson, Bee. 2020. Flour Fixated. https://www.lrb.co.uk/the-paper/v42/n18/bee-wilson/flour-fixated (accessed 7 July 2024). - Wilson, Bee. 2022. How we lost our sensory connection with food – and how to restore it. https://www.theguardian.com/food/2022/mar/29/how-we-lost-our-sensory-connection-with-food-and-how-to-restore-it (accessed 11 June 2024). - Mintz, Sidney. 1995. 'Food and its relationship to concepts of

	power'. In <i>Food and Agrarian Orders in the World-Economy</i>, ed. Philip McMichael, 3-13. Westport, CT: Praeger. • Proust, Marcel. 1922. 'The Cookie'. In <i>Remembrance of Things Past. Volume 1: Swann's Way: Within a Budding Grove. The Definitive French Pleiade edition</i>, ed. C.K. Scott Moncrieff and Terence Kilmartin, 48-51. New York: Vintage Books.
Optional Readings	• Abaraca, Meredith. 2015. 'Culinary Mestizaje: An Afro-Latino Collective Sensory Memory'. <i>Dialogo</i> 18(1): 101-12.

Session 2: 'You Eat what you Are'—Tastes, Cultures & Identity

Learning Objective	What we eat is often not arbitrary but a function of all sorts of factors. This session introduces some factors we should think about and invites their critical reflection.
Required Readings	• Fischler, Claude. 1988. 'Food, Self and Identity'. <i>Social Science Information</i> 27(2): 275-92. • Shapin, Steven. 2014. "You Are What You Eat": Historical Changes in Ideas About Food and Identity'. <i>Historical Research</i> 87(237): 377-92. • Tobias, Z., and J. M. Dieterle. 2023. 'Identity and Food Choice: You Are What You Eat?'. <i>Food Ethics</i> 8(1): 1-17. • Hauck-Lawson, Annie S. 1998. 'When Food is the Voice: A Case Study of a Polish-American Woman'. <i>Journal for the Study of Food and Society</i> 2(1): 21-28. • Smith, Bobby J., and Joseph C. Ewoodzie. 2021. 'Listening to Zenani's Food Voice: Recovering Contemporary Black Foodways in Southern Food Studies'. <i>Food, Culture & Society</i>: 1-13.
Optional Readings	• Appadurai, Arjun. 1988. 'How to Make a National Cuisine: Cookbooks in Contemporary India'. <i>Comparative Studies in Society and History</i> 30(1): 3-24. • Goldstein, Darra et al. 2005. <i>Culinary Cultures of Europe: Identity, Diversity and Dialogue</i>. Strasbourg: Council of Europe Publishing. • Deutsch, Jonathan. 2004. "'Eat Me Up'". <i>Food, Culture & Society</i> 7(1): 27-36.

Session 3: The World Food Economy—the Past: *Sweetness & Power*

Learning Objective	Some of the food we eat travels far and undergoes various processes. This session investigates 'the past' and takes the example of sugar to unpack the link between food, socio-economic development and imperial expansion.
Required Readings	• Mintz, Sidney Wilfred. 1986. <i>Sweetness and Power: The Place of Sugar in Modern History</i>. New York: Penguin, esp. intro, chaps 2, 3 & 4.

Optional Readings	• Carney, Judith. 2008. 'Reconsidering Sweetness and Power Through a Gendered Lens'. <i>Food and Foodways</i> 16(2): 127-34. • Merleaux, A. 2015. 'Sweetness, Power, and Forgotten Food Histories in America's Empire'. <i>Labor Studies in Working-Class History of the Americas</i> 12(1-2): 87-114. • https://digipodcast.org/2020/01/19/bittersweet-sugar-slavery-empire-and-consumerism-in-the-atlantic-world/ • Mintz, Sidney. 2008. 'Response'. <i>Food and Foodways</i> 16(2): 148-58.
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Session 4: The World Food Economy—the Present

Learning Objective	What is the modern global food system? How does it work? What are its effects? Who controls it?
Required Readings	• De Schutter, Olivier. 2017. 'The Political Economy of Food Systems Reform'. <i>European Review of Agricultural Economics</i> 44(4): 705-31. • Clapp, Jennifer, and William G. Moseley. 2020. 'This Food Crisis is Different: Covid-19 and the Fragility of the Neoliberal Food Security Order'. <i>The Journal of Peasant Studies</i> 47(7): 1393-417. • Enloe, Cynthia H. 2014. 'Going Bananas! Where Are Women in the International Politics of Bananas?'. In <i>Bananas, Beaches and Bases: Making Feminist Sense of International Politics</i>, 211-49. Berkeley, CA: University of California Press. • Gulati, Ashok et al. 2021. Food System in India: Challenges, Performance and Promise. Center for Development Research (ZEF) in cooperation with the Scientific https://bonndoc.ulb.uni-bonn.de/xmlui/bitstream/handle/20.500.11811/9136/025_FSS_Brief_Food_Systems_India.pdf?sequence=1&isAllowed=y (accessed 16 July 2022).
Optional Readings	• Janes, Lauren et al. 2019. 'World War I and the Origins of the Modern Food System'. <i>Global Food History</i> 5(3): 224-38. • Metcalfe, Robyn Shotwell. 2019. 'Our Food Supply Chain at a Glance'. In <i>Food Routes: Growing bananas in Iceland and other tales from the logistics of eating</i>, 9-27. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.

Session 5: The Political Economy of Food Regulation

Learning Objective	What is food regulation? What explains the state of food regulation in different countries?
Required Readings	• Swinnen, Johan. 2017. 'Some Dynamic Aspects of Food Standards'. <i>American Journal of Agricultural Economics</i> 99(2): 321-38. • Pruchniewicz, Karolina, and Tomasz Srogosz. 2020. 'The Codex Alimentarius Standards Decision-Making: Some Critical Remarks on an Ongoing Discussion'. <i>European Food & Feed Law Review</i> 15: 571-

	78. • Murphy, Brendon, and Jay Sanderson. 2017. 'Soft Law, Responsibility and the Biopolitics of Front-of-pack Food Labels'. <i>Griffith Law Review</i> 26(3): 355-77.
Optional Readings	• Swinnen, Johan, and Thijs Vandemoortele. 2011. 'The Political Economy of Food Standards'. In <i>The Oxford Handbook of the Economics of Food Consumption and Policy</i>, ed. Lusk, Jayson L., Jutta Roosen, and Jason F. Shogren, 415-37. Oxford: Oxford University Press. • Yngfalk, Carl. 2016. "Bio-Politicizing Consumption: Neo-Liberal Consumerism and Disembodiment in the Food Marketplace". <i>Consumption Markets & Culture</i> 19:275-95.

Session 6: The State & the Healthy 'Body Politic'—Pregnancy, Dietary Recommendations & Science

Learning Objective	Public health campaigns often take the shape of dietary campaigns, especially when it comes to pregnancy. What should pregnant women eat and drink? How does science shape this advice? What impact do cultural images of pregnancy and the female body have?
Required Readings	• Mansfield, Becky. 2012. 'Gendered Biopolitics of Public Health: Regulation and Discipline in Seafood Consumption Advisories'. <i>Environment and Planning D: Society and Space</i> 30(4): 588-602. • Parker, George. 2014. 'Mothers at Large: Responsibilizing the Pregnant Self for the "Obesity Epidemic"'. <i>Fat Studies</i> 3(2): 101-18. • Gil-Riaño, Sebastián, and Sarah E. Tracy. 2016. 'Developing Constipation: Dietary Fiber, Western Disease, and Industrial Carbohydrates'. <i>Global Food History</i> 2: 179-209. • Paxson, Heather. 2016. 'Rethinking food and its eaters: opening the black boxes of safety and nutrition'. In <i>The Handbook of Food and Anthropology</i>, ed. Jacob A. Klein and James L. Watson, 268-88. London: Bloomsbury Academic. • https://www.nationalgeographic.com/culture/article/eat-this-not-that-taboos-and-pregnancy • https://www.healthline.com/health/pregnancy/pregnancy-recommendations-around-the-world#Pregnancy-Around-the-World
Optional Readings	• Taylor, Chloe. 2019. 'Foucault and Food'. In <i>Encyclopedia of Food and Agricultural Ethics</i>, ed. Kaplan, D.M., 1355-61. Dordrecht: Springer Netherlands. • Murphy, Elizabeth. 2000. 'Risk, Responsibility, and Rhetoric in Infant Feeding'. <i>Journal of Contemporary Ethnography</i> 29(3): 291-325.

Session 7: Food Sustainability – Concepts & Diagnosis

Learning Objective	The sustainability of food production and consumption has moved to the centre ground of the debates around climate change and the environmental effects of food 'democratisation'. This week we look into aspects of this debate.
Required Readings	• Rockström, Johan et al. 2025. 'The Eat-Lancet Commission on Healthy, Sustainable, and Just Food Systems'. <i>Lancet</i> 406(10512): 1625-51. • Poore, Joseph, and Thomas Nemecek. 2018. 'Reducing Food's Environmental Impacts Through Producers and Consumers'. <i>Science</i> 360(6392): 987-92. • Ball, Thomas S. et al. 2025. 'Food Impacts on Species Extinction Risks Can Vary by Three Orders of Magnitude'. <i>Nature Food</i> 6(9): 848-56. • Boakes, Elizabeth H et al. 2024. 'Impacts of the Global Food System on Terrestrial Biodiversity From Land Use and Climate Change'. <i>Nature Communications</i> 15(1): 5750. • Leal Filho, Walter et al. 2025. 'Dinner is Served: How Climate Change Interferes with Olive Oil Production'. <i>Sustainability Science</i>: 0.
Optional Readings	• Schmitt, Emilia et al. 2017. 'Comparing the Sustainability of Local and Global Food Products in Europe'. <i>Journal of Cleaner Production</i> 165: 346-59. • Smith, Pete et al. 2024. 'Status of the World's Soils'. <i>Annual Review of Environment and Resources</i> 49: 73-104.

Mid-term Break: no class

Session 8: Food Sustainability – Actions & Practices

Learning Objective	Food sustainability needs to be turned into practice. This session investigates some of these practices, evaluates them and puts them into context.
Required Readings	• Rockström, Johan et al. 2025. 'The Eat-Lancet Commission on Healthy, Sustainable, and Just Food Systems'. <i>Lancet</i> 406(10512): 1651-61. • Madsen, Sidney et al. 2025. 'Agroecology Supports Sustainable Development in Africa. A Review'. <i>Agronomy for Sustainable Development</i> 45(4): 34. • Fan, Shenggen, Karli Verghese, and Leah Lizarondo. 2019. 'Low-Hanging Fruit: Reducing Food Waste By 2030'. <i>One Earth</i> 1(3): 269-71.
Optional	• Mann, Alana et al. 2025. 'Ethical Entrepreneurship in a Not-for-profit Kitchen Incubator: Foodlab Sydney'. <i>Food Ethics</i> 10(2): 0 • Bezner Kerr, Rachel et al. 2021. 'Can Agroecology Improve Food Security and Nutrition? A Review'. <i>Global Food Security</i> 29: 100540.

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Session 9: Food Deserts, Food Swamps & Food Poverty

Learning Objective	While there is food in abundance in modern societies. Access to healthy and affordable food is unequally distributed. The notion of food deserts and food swamps articulate this fact. This session investigates this development, what accounts for it and what can be done about it.
Required Readings	• Ares, Gastón et al. 2024. 'Weird and Non-Consensual Food Deserts and Swamps: A Scoping Review of Operational Definitions'. <i>Health Place</i> 89: 103315. • Zhen, Chen. 2021. 'Food Deserts: Myth or Reality'. <i>Annual Review of Resource Economics</i> 13. • Yang, Meng, Haoluan Wang, and Feng Qiu. 2020. 'Neighbourhood Food Environments Revisited: When Food Deserts Meet Food Swamps'. <i>The Canadian Geographer / Le Géographe canadien</i> 64(1): 135-54. • Bridle-Fitzpatrick, Susan. 2015. 'Food Deserts or Food Swamps?: A Mixed-Methods Study of Local Food Environments in a Mexican City'. <i>Social Science & Medicine</i> 142: 202-13.
Optional Readings	• Gebremariam, Alemayehu Digssie, Katherine Kent, and Karen Charlton. 2025. 'The Association Between Community Food Environments and Health Outcomes in High-Income Countries: A Systematic Literature Review'. <i>Current Nutrition Reports</i> 14(1): 74. • Jürgens, Ulrich. 2018. "Real' Versus 'Mental' Food Deserts From the Consumer Perspective—Concepts and Quantitative Methods Applied to Rural Areas of Germany'. <i>DIE ERDE—Journal of the Geographical Society of Berlin</i> 149(1): 25-43. • Hamidi, Shima. 2020. 'Urban Sprawl and the Emergence of Food Deserts in the USA'. <i>Urban Studies</i> 57(8): 1660-75. • Yang, Meng, Haoluan Wang, and Feng Qiu. 2020. 'Neighbourhood Food Environments Revisited: When Food Deserts Meet Food Swamps'. <i>The Canadian Geographer / Le Géographe canadien</i> 64(1): 135-54.

Session 10: National Food Strategies & the Debate about Food Security

Learning Objective	Food security is a concern of every state. This session looks into national food strategies, their key aspects and differences.
Required Readings	• Petrikova, Ivica. 2019. 'Food-Security Governance in India and Ethiopia: A Comparative Analysis'. <i>Third World Quarterly</i> 40(4): 743-62. • Dong, Kevin et al. 2024. 'China's Food Security: Key Challenges and Emerging Policy Responses'. CSIS Briefs.

	• FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP, WHO. 2025. The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2025. Rome: FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP, WHO.
Optional Readings	• Beyranevand, Laurie J, and Emily M Leib. 2017. 'Making the case for a national food strategy in the United States'. <i>Food & Drug Law Journal</i> 72: 225-61. • Hall, Derek. 2020. 'National food security through corporate globalization: Japanese strategies in the global grain trade since the 2007–8 food crisis'. <i>The Journal of Peasant Studies</i> 47(5): 993-1029.

Session 11: Social Movements, Food Production & Consumption—Food as Social & Political Catalyst

Learning Objective	Food is a social and political catalyst. This session looks into the nexus between food and social mobilization.
Required Readings	• Anderl, Felix, and Michael Hißen. 2024. 'How Trust is Lost: The Food Systems Summit 2021 and the Delegitimation of UN Food Governance'. <i>European Journal of International Relations</i> 30(1): 151-75. • Asempapa, Clara Emefa et al. 2025. How to Strengthen Democracy and Empowerment through Economic Activity. https://rebalanceproject.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/Policy-Brief-3_Democratic-organizing_final.pdf (accessed 20 Sep 2025). • van Bommel, Koen, and André Spicer. 2011. 'Hail the Snail: Hegemonic Struggles in the Slow Food Movement'. <i>Organization Studies</i> 32(12): 1717-44. • Mann, Alana. 2017. 'Food sovereignty and the politics of food scarcity'. In <i>Global Resource Scarcity: Catalyst for conflict or cooperation?</i>, ed. Marcelle C. Dawson, Christopher Rosin and Navé Wald, 131-45. London: Routledge.
Optional Readings	• Haydu, Jeffrey, and Tad Skotnicki. 2016. 'Three Layers of History in Recurrent Social Movements: The Case of Food Reform'. <i>Social Movement Studies</i> 15(4): 345-60. • Schurman, Rachel. 2004. 'Fighting "Frankenfoods": Industry Opportunity Structures and the Efficacy of the Anti-Biotech Movement in Western Europe'. <i>Social Problems</i> 51(2): 243-68. • Wren, Gavin. 2017. Culinary Luddism and The Downside of Slow Food. https://brainfoodstudio.com/uncategorized/culinary-luddism-slow-food/ (accessed 13 July 2021).

Session 12: The Future of Food Production & Consumption

Learning Objective	The final session takes stock of what we have discussed so far and looks to the future of food production, distribution and consumption.
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Required Readings	Parasecoli, Fabio. 2020. Technology can help us feed the world, if we look beyond profit: Powerful technologies like genetic modification aren't the enemy of a healthy, sustainable food system. MIT Technology Review. https://www.technologyreview.com/2020/12/18/1013215/food-technology-sustainability-capitalism-pandemic-gmos/ (accessed 14 June 2021).
Optional Readings	TBA

Final Exam Week: no class